

Haoran Sun

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Employment

- 05.2025-to
date Researcher
 Project - 'Smart & Scale Up' of Regional SMEs
- 2023-04.2025 Research Fellow, University of St Andrews
 ESRC Funded - Understanding how constraints on access to finance and under-investment
 impact on productivity growth in smaller firms

Education

- 2017-2023 PhD in Economics, Durham University
 ESRC Funded - Tax Incentives for innovation
 Thesis: [The Economics of Innovation, Investment, and Taxation](#)
- 2018 Visiting PhD in Economics, University of Exeter
- 2015-2017 MSc in Economics (Distinction), Durham University
- 2012-2015 BA in Economics (2:1 Honours), Durham University

Publication

Unpacking the Money-Distance Nexus: Mapping the Spatial Configuration of Exogenous Entrepreneurial Finance across UK Entrepreneurial Ecosystems

Ross Brown, Augusto Rocha, Haoran Sun, Marc Cowling
Small Business Economics (ABS3)

Why do Owls Fly While Ostriches Flounder? SME Advice, Impacts and Entrepreneurial Outcomes

Ross Brown; Marc Cowling, Weixi Liu, Sabrina Song, Haoran Sun
Journal of Small Business Management (ABS3)

Working Paper

Spatial Myopia, Financial Hubs and the “Golden Triangle”: Tracing the Uneven Landscape of Exogenous Equity Investments in the UK

Ross Brown, Haoran Sun, Augusto Rocha, Marc Cowling
British Journal of Management (ABS4), Revise & Resubmit

Can We See it in the Numbers Yet? Artificial Intelligence, Firm-Level Productivity and SMEs

Ross Brown; Haoran Sun, Marc Cowling, Dowell David
Technovation (ABS3), under review

Does “Slow” Thinking “Speed Up” Performance? The Impact of “Guided Preparation” on Innovation and Productivity in UK SMEs

Ross Brown, Haoran Sun, Weixi Liu, Marc Cowling, Sabrina Song
Industry and Innovation (ABS3), under review

The Effect of Direct and Indirect Support for Innovation on Productivity: Evidence from Young UK Businesses

John Moffat, Haoran Sun
Working in progress - final draft

Two Country Model of R&D Investment

Nigar Hashimzade, Haoran Sun
Working in progress - final draft

Taxing the Clouds: An Economic Analysis

Nigar Hashimzade, Haoran Sun
Working in progress - final draft

Grants

2024 ERC - DBT: Small Grant Funding, £5000
Ross Brown, Marc Cowling, Haoran Sun

Presentation

2024 ERC - DBT: Longitudinal Small Business Survey Dissemination Event, London
Advice and SMEs: Who Takes it and What Happens Thereafter

2024 ZEW: Competition and Innovation Summer School, Montenegro
Impacts of Business Advice on UK SMEs

Teaching

2025-	Econometrics, Durham University
2020	Macroeconomics, Durham University
2019	Corporate Finance, Durham University

Honours & Awards

2019- to date	Accredited Researcher, Office of National Statistics
2017-2022	NINE Doctoral Training Partnership Studentship, ESRC
2017-2021	Research Training Support Grant, ESRC

Computer Skills

Stata, L^AT_EX, Maple, Matlab, Python, Eviews, SPSS, NVivo

Languages

English: Professional proficiency

Mandarin: Native proficiency